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The passage is primarily concerned with

A. presenting various groups' views of the motives of those proposing certain legislation

B. contrasting the reasoning of various groups concerning their positions on certain proposed legislation

C. tracing the process whereby certain proposed legislation was eventually enacted

D. assessing the success of tactics adopted by various groups with respect to certain proposed legislation

E. evaluating the arguments of various groups concerning certain proposed legislation

Main Idea

Answering this question depends on identifying the overall point of the passage. The passage is mainly concerned with explaining the reasons behind the positions taken by WIDC and SPEW, which opposed the proposal to enact legislation prohibiting women from holding most white lead factory jobs, and the reasoning of WTUL, which supported the proposal.

A. The passage explains how WIDC viewed the proposal, but it does not indicate what any of the groups believed about the motivations of the Home Secretary, who made the proposal.

B. **Correct.** The passage contrasts the reasoning of the WIDC and SPEW, both of which believed that enforcing safety regulations would make the proposed legislation unnecessary, with the reasoning of WTUL, which thought that safety regulations were unlikely to be enforced and thus supported the proposal.

C. The passage simply states that the proposal was eventually enacted; it does not trace the process by which this occurred.

D. The passage implies that WIDC and SPEW were unsuccessful in their opposition to the proposed legislation, but it identifies only one tactic used in opposition to it: SPEW's attempt to challenge it by investigating the causes of lead poisoning.

E. The passage does not evaluate the groups' arguments concerning the proposed legislation; rather, it presents those arguments without comment on their quality or value.

The correct answer is B.

Questions 572–577 refer to the passage on page 484.

572. The author of the passage refers to Robert Filmer (see line 9) primarily in order to

A. show that Royalist ideology was somewhat more radical than most historians appear to realize

B. qualify the claim that patriarchalism formed the basis of Royalist ideology

C. question the view that most early feminists were associated with the Royalist faction

D. highlight an apparent tension between Royalist ideology and the ideas of early feminists

E. argue that Royalists held conflicting opinions on issues of family organization and women's political rights

Evaluation

This question asks about the role of Filmer in the passage. The author states that Filmer's radical patriarchalism is associated with Royalist ideology and then goes on to define radical patriarchalism as an ideology that asserts the power of the king and the male head of the household. Early feminists, however, questioned the subordination of women in marriage. Thus, there seems to be a conflict between these two sets of ideas.

A. Although the passage refers to Filmer's view as *radical patriarchalism*, it provides no evidence regarding any differences in the degrees to which historians consider that view, or Royalism in general, to be radical.

B. Filmer's work supports the claim that patriarchalism was the basis of Royalist ideology; it does not qualify such a claim.

C. That Filmer's approach was one of radical patriarchalism makes it surprising that early feminists were associated with the Royalist faction, but it does not provide any grounds for questioning whether they were so associated.

D. **Correct.** There is apparent tension between Filmer's radical patriarchalism, if that is indeed essential to Royalist ideology, and the ideas of early feminists, who questioned such patriarchalism.

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E. The author refers to Filmer in order to suggest, initially, a uniformity among Royalists regarding family and women; it is only later in the passage that this view becomes more complicated.

The correct answer is D.

573. The passage suggests which of the following about the seventeenth-century English women mentioned in line 2?

A. Their status as forerunners of modern feminism is not entirely justified.

B. They did not openly challenge the radical patriarchalism of Royalist Filmerian ideology.

C. Cavendish was the first among these women to criticize women's subordination in marriage and assert women's equality with men.

D. Their views on family organization and women's political rights were diametrically opposed to those of both Royalist and Parliamentarian ideology.

E. Historians would be less puzzled if more of them were identified with the Parliamentarian side in the English Civil Wars.

Inference

The first sentence of the passage refers to women who are both regarded as forerunners of modern feminism and identified as Royalists. The passage goes on to suggest that, given Royalist ideology's association with Filmer's radical patriarchalism (equating absolute power of the king with absolute power of the male head of household), it is surprising that feminism would find any footing within such an ideology.

A. Nothing in the passage disputes the idea that the seventeenth-century English women in question should be considered the forerunners of modern feminism.

B. Gallagher provides the example of Margaret Cavendish as a writer who did openly challenge radical patriarchalism—albeit only in her writings.

C. The passage states that Cavendish had successors among early feminists, but it does not indicate whether she herself was the first seventeenth-century English woman to assert women's equality.

D. The passage does not indicate what the Parliamentarian view of family organization and women's political rights was, so there is no way to determine whether the Royalist forerunners of modern feminism were opposed to that view.

E. **Correct.** The basic puzzle the passage sets out to solve is why the forerunners of modern feminism would have been associated with the Royalist side, which seems to have been based on radical patriarchalism. Historians would most likely have been less surprised if these women had been identified with the Parliamentarian side, which presumably did not embrace radical patriarchalism.

The correct answer is E.

574. The passage suggests that Margaret Cavendish's decision to become an author was motivated, at least in part, by a desire to

A. justify her support for the Royalist cause

B. encourage her readers to work toward eradicating Filmerian patriarchalism

C. persuade other women to break free from their political and social isolation

D. analyze the causes for women's exclusion from the pursuit of power

E. create a world over which she could exercise total control

Inference

This question asks about Margaret Cavendish's reasons for becoming an author. The second paragraph describes her as someone who *insisted that she was a self-sufficient being*; she understood that, given the real-world strictures in place, she could achieve this self-sufficiency in her own mind and on paper as a writer. So her decision to become a writer can be inferred to be motivated by her desire to exercise power and control.

A. The passage states that Cavendish justified her being the center of her own universe by invoking the Royalist figure of the absolute monarch; there is no suggestion in the passage that Cavendish felt the need to justify any support for the actual Royalist cause.

B. The passage gives no direct indication that Cavendish was even aware of Filmerian patriarchalism.

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B. The passage gives no direct indication that Cavendish was even aware of Filmerian patriarchalism.

C. The second paragraph states that Cavendish's idea of absolute singularity carried with it the idea of social and political isolation; Cavendish was most likely not motivated by a desire to persuade other women to break free from such isolation.

D. Cavendish took the exclusion of women from the pursuit of power for granted; the passage does not suggest that she was concerned with its causes.

E. **Correct.** According to the passage, Cavendish considered herself a self-sufficient being who was at the center of her own universe; in her writing, she wanted to create a world in which this was also true.

The correct answer is E.

575. The phrase "a satellite orbiting a dominant male planet" (lines 41–42) refers most directly to

A. Cavendish's concept that each woman is a sovereign self

B. the complete political and social isolation of absolute singularity

C. the immaterial world that a writer can create on paper

D. the absolute subordination of women in a patriarchal society

E. the metaphorical figure of the absolute monarch

Evaluation

The phrase in question is *a satellite orbiting a dominant male planet*. The passage states that this was the idea that Cavendish was reacting against; she preferred instead the idea that she was the center of her own universe, her own sovereign, subject to no one.

A. The idea of a satellite orbiting a dominant male planet refers not to Cavendish's idea that each woman is a sovereign self, but rather to the idea directly opposed to that: each woman must submit to a dominant male.

B. A *satellite orbiting a dominant male planet* is by definition not isolated, nor is it singular.

C. According to the passage, Cavendish wished to create her own world as a writer so that she did not have to be a *satellite*.

D. **Correct.** The phrase refers to the idea that in a patriarchal society, women are as satellites to men, who are the dominant planets.

E. While radical patriarchy does equate the monarch with the male head of the household, the phrase in question is most directly about the relationship, under patriarchy, between women and men.

The correct answer is D.

576. The primary purpose of the passage is to

A. trace the historical roots of a modern sociopolitical movement

B. present one scholar's explanation for a puzzling historical phenomenon

C. contrast two interpretations of the ideological origins of a political conflict

D. establish a link between the ideology of an influential political theorist and that of a notoriously eccentric writer

E. call attention to some points of agreement between opposing sides in an ideological debate

Main Idea

This question asks about the passage as a whole. The passage is mainly concerned with outlining Catherine Gallagher's attempt to explain why, given Royalist ideology's apparent association with radical patriarchalism, Royalist women offered feminist critiques of women's subordination in marriage and asserted their equality with men.

A. The passage makes no connection between early feminism and its modern form.

B. **Correct.** The passage presents a puzzling historical phenomenon, that Royalist women critiqued patriarchalism, in the first paragraph, and then presents Catherine Gallagher's explanation for that phenomenon in the second paragraph.

C. While the passage discusses the political conflict between the Royalists and Parliamentarians in the English Civil Wars in the first paragraph, neither this conflict, nor its ideological origins are the focus of the

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Civil Wars in the first paragraph, neither this conflict, nor its ideological origins are the focus of the passage. Furthermore, the passage does not offer any interpretations of the origins of the conflict.

D. The passage attempts to unlink the ideology of political theorist Robert Filmer and the eccentric author Margaret Cavendish by suggesting that Filmer's radical patriarchalism was not the only way of understanding Royalist ideology. Cavendish provided a different understanding entirely.

E. While both sides of the ideological debate did agree on the absolute monarchy, the passage as a whole does not focus on this agreement, but rather on the disagreement about where, theoretically, the idea of absolute monarchy leads.

The correct answer is B.

577. Which of the following, if true, would most clearly undermine Gallagher's explanation of the link between Royalism and feminism?

A. Because of their privileged backgrounds, Royalist women were generally better educated than were their Parliamentarian counterparts.

B. Filmer himself had read some of Cavendish's early writings and was highly critical of her ideas.

C. Cavendish's views were highly individual and were not shared by the other Royalist women who wrote early feminist works.

D. The Royalist and Parliamentarian ideologies were largely in agreement on issues of family organization and women's political rights.

E. The Royalist side included a sizable minority faction that was opposed to the more radical tendencies of Filmerian patriarchalism.

Inference

This question asks about how to undermine the way in which Gallagher connects Royalism and feminism. According to Gallagher, Cavendish's work exemplifies the connection between these ideas, because Cavendish took the idea of absolute monarchy and extended that to the idea of absolute self, an idea that should, Cavendish believed, apply to women as well as men.

A. Gallagher's explanation of the link between Royalism and feminism does not depend on the education level of Royalist women relative to Parliamentarian women.

B. Filmer most likely would have been critical of Cavendish's ideas, had he encountered them, but the passage does not indicate that Gallagher's argument had anything to do with whether Filmer read Cavendish's writings.

C. **Correct.** Gallagher uses Cavendish's work to explain how Royalism gave rise to feminism, but if Cavendish's views were completely atypical of other Royalist women, then those views cannot explain the link as Gallagher suggests they do.

D. The passage states in the first paragraph that if the Royalists and Parliamentarians were in agreement *on issues of family organization and women's political rights*, then feminists should have been divided between the two sides—but they were not. So this idea, if true, would undermine that statement, but not Gallagher's argument about the link between Royalists and feminists.

E. If more Royalists were opposed to Filmer's radical patriarchalism, then Cavendish's writings would seem to be more representative of tendencies in Royalist ideology, thus making Gallagher's case stronger, not weaker.

The correct answer is C.

Questions 578–580 refer to the passage on page 486.

578. According to the passage, Faue's study and Gabin's study agree in that both

A. attribute the inclusion of women in unions to the policies of the CIO

B. emphasize the importance of unions at the community level

C. argue that women played important roles in the establishment of industrial union organizations

D. suggest that women in industrial union organizations played a subordinate role

E. suggest that the interests of women workers were incompatible with those of unions in general

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E. suggest that the interests of women workers were incompatible with those of unions in general

Evaluation

The passage discusses two studies of trade unionism in the United States: Elizabeth Faue's study of the labor movement in Minneapolis in the 1930s and the 1940s, and Nancy Gabin's study of industrial unions from the 1930s to the 1970s. What do the two studies have in common?

A. The passage indicates that according to Faue, the CIO during the years studied professed nondiscrimination and inclusion, but in practice marginalized women. Gabin's study indicates that though women encountered male domination in the unions, they were able to advance their interests in some CIO unions.

B. The passage describes Faue's finding that at a community level, women had been important in building up the labor movement, but this contribution was not reflected in the operation of unions in the 1940s. The passage does not ascribe any emphasis on the importance of unionism at the community level to Gabin.

C. Faue's account credits women with building up unionism at local community level. Gabin's study does not describe such a role as performed by women, even though women workers are portrayed as active in unions on behalf of women's issues.

D. **Correct.** The passage represents the studies by Faue and by Gabin as suggesting that women were largely marginalized in terms of holding leadership roles in unions.

E. As described in the passage, Gabin's study indicates that women could make some progress on advancing the interests of women workers in at least some unions. Faue's account, the passage suggests, portrays women's contributions as having become "increasingly irrelevant to unions' institutional life" when unions had become strong.

The correct answer is D.

579. Which of the following can be inferred regarding the gender ideology mentioned in line 6?

A. It prevented women from making significant contributions to the establishment of industrial unions.

B. It resulted from the marginalization of women in industrial unions.

C. It had a significant effect on the advancement of women's issues within industrial unions.

D. Its primary tenets were nondiscrimination and inclusion.

E. Its effects were mitigated by the growth of industrial unions.

Inference

The passage indicates that "the prevailing gender ideology" was largely incompatible with the CIO's professed commitment to "principles of nondiscrimination and inclusion." The ideology in question tended toward a preference for male leadership. For example, Faue is cited as arguing that "women were marginalized by union bureaucratization" as unions disengaged from the community base with which women had been vitally involved.

A. The passage indicates that women made such contributions in the early stages of trade union growth at community level, so this was not precluded by the gender ideology.

B. The passage represents the marginalization as an effect rather than a cause of the gender ideology.

C. **Correct.** Without significant representation in leadership roles, occupied mainly, if not exclusively, by men, one can infer that women's issues likely fell by the wayside. Moreover, as the community base became "increasingly irrelevant to unions' institutional life," women's issues in the community were largely ignored by unions.

D. The passage indicates that though these principles were professed by unions, they tended to be largely ignored in practice in relation to women's roles and their interests.

E. Women were active at community level in the growth of unions, the passage tells us, citing Faue. However, as unions grew powerful, the "gender ideology" mentioned, far from being mitigated, was only reinforced.

The correct answer is C.

580. The author of the passage is primarily concerned with

A. presenting two views

B. reconciling two antithetical claims

C. assessing conflicting evidence

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C. assessing conflicting evidence

D. weakening a generally accepted argument

E. tracing the development of an ideology

Main Idea

What does the passage suggest is the author's primary purpose?

A. **Correct.** The author summarizes the views of two scholars regarding the contributions of women to the development of trade unionism in industrial settings in the United States, as well as some negative aspects in women's experience with trade unions.

B. The two views discussed in the passage are presented as differing with respect to the degree to which women succeeded at various times in their efforts to "advance their interests as women" in industrial trade unions, but these views are not strictly antithetical.

C. References to conflicting evidence occur in the passage, but assessing that evidence is not the author's primary concern.

D. No information tending to weaken an argument the passage represents as generally accepted is to be found in the passage.

E. The author indicates that both historical studies agree in seeing the persistence of a gender ideology of male domination in the culture and leadership of many industrial trade unions in the United States over several decades from the 1930s. However, the author does not trace the development of that ideology.

The correct answer is A.

Questions 581–586 refer to the passage on page 487.

581. The primary purpose of the passage is to

A. assess the validity of a certain view

B. distinguish between two phenomena

C. identify the causes of a problem

D. describe a disturbing trend

E. allay concern about a particular phenomenon

Main Idea

This question requires understanding, in general terms, the purpose of the passage as a whole. The first paragraph identifies an area of concern: declines in amphibian populations may constitute a crisis, one that indicates humans' catastrophic effects on the environment. The rest of the passage then goes on to evaluate, as the second paragraph states, whether claims of crisis-level extinctions as a result of human activity are valid. In making this evaluation, the passage discusses the possible causes of extinctions, biologists' prioritization of population declines over extinctions, and the fact that we lack extensive long-term data on amphibian populations.

A. **Correct.** The passage's main purpose is to assess whether the view that humans are causing crisis-level declines in amphibian populations is valid.

B. The passage takes care, particularly in the third paragraph, to distinguish between population declines and extinctions, but this is not its primary purpose.

C. The passage makes clear that it is difficult to identify the real extent of the problem facing amphibian populations, much less identify its causes.

D. The first paragraph notes what may seem to be a disturbing trend—the decline in amphibian populations—but the rest of the passage is concerned not with describing that trend in greater detail, but rather with determining whether it is in fact occurring.

E. While the passage provides possible grounds for concluding that concern about declining amphibian populations is overblown, it concludes by suggesting that we might, because we lack data, doom species and ecosystems to extinction. Thus, the overall purpose is not to allay concern.

The correct answer is A.

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582. It can be inferred from the passage that the author believes which of the following to be true of the environmentalists mentioned in lines 5–6?

A. They have wrongly chosen to focus on anecdotal reports rather than on the long-term data that are currently available concerning amphibians.

B. Their recommendations are flawed because their research focuses too narrowly on a single category of animal species.

C. Their certainty that population declines in general are caused by environmental degradation is not warranted.

D. They have drawn premature conclusions concerning a crisis in amphibian populations from recent reports of declines.

E. They have overestimated the effects of chance events on trends in amphibian populations.

Inference

This question asks about the author's view of the environmentalists mentioned in the first paragraph. These environmentalists have claimed, based on amphibian population declines, that the situation is a crisis and that immediate action must be taken. The author, however, states that the declines are only *apparently* drastic and questions whether they are real, thus suggesting that the environmentalists are drawing conclusions in the absence of a complete consideration of the situation.

A. The passage indicates that anecdotal reports are insufficient, but so too are other resources. The fourth paragraph of the passage makes clear that there is not enough long-term data available on which to base conclusions about amphibian populations.

B. The passage does not indicate that the environmentalists under discussion have conducted research on any animal species.

C. The passage does not indicate that the environmentalists in question hold, with certainty, any particular view regarding population declines in general.

D. **Correct.** The author argues that the recent declines may have several different causes, and that environmentalists have jumped to a conclusion about the cause of the declines as well as their significance.

E. The environmentalists, in attributing population declines to intentional human activity, have more likely underestimated than overestimated the effects of chance events on amphibian populations.

The correct answer is D.

583. It can be inferred from the passage that the author believes which of the following to be true of the amphibian extinctions that have recently been reported?

A. They have resulted primarily from human activities causing environmental degradation.

B. They could probably have been prevented if timely action had been taken to protect the habitats of amphibian species.

C. They should not come as a surprise, because amphibian populations generally have been declining for a number of years.

D. They have probably been caused by a combination of chance events.

E. They do not clearly constitute evidence of general environmental degradation.

Inference

The author suggests throughout the passage that recently reported amphibian extinctions may have several different causes: they may be due to any number of chance events, for example, or may simply be the result of a small population that finds itself unable to continue under difficult conditions, whatever causes those conditions.

A. The author states in the second paragraph that extinctions may occur without a proximate cause in human activities and does not make a commitment to any particular explanation of the amphibian extinctions.

B. That chance events can cause extinctions suggests that even if habitats had been protected, extinctions still might have occurred.

C. In the second paragraph, the author says that extinctions *should come as no great surprise*, but this option is imprecise. The amphibian populations have not generally *been declining for a number of years*. The author

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imprecise. The amphibian populations have not generally *been declining for a number of years*. The author says in the third paragraph that amphibian populations show strong fluctuations; further, in the fourth paragraph, the author says that there is insufficient long-term data to conclude that amphibian populations have been, or are, in decline.

D. The author suggests that the extinctions may have been caused by chance events, but there is not enough data to know whether or not this is probable.

E. **Correct.** The reported extinctions could have resulted from several different causes; thus, they are not clear evidence of general environmental degradation.

The correct answer is E.

584. According to the passage, each of the following is true of endangered amphibian species EXCEPT:

A. They are among the rarest kinds of amphibians.

B. They generally have populations that are small in size.

C. They are in constant danger of extinction.

D. Those with decreasing populations are the most likely candidates for immediate extinction.

E. They are in danger of extinction due to events that sometimes have nothing to do with human activities.

Application

This question asks what the passage does not say is true of endangered amphibian species. The second paragraph discusses endangered species, stating that they are *always rare, almost always small, and, by definition, under constant threat of extinction*, which may be caused by chance events. The possibility of their extinction, the passage states, depends only on the population size, and not whether that population is increasing or decreasing.

A. The second paragraph mentions rarity as a characteristic of endangered amphibian species.

B. According to the second paragraph, endangered amphibian species are generally those of small populations.

C. The second paragraph states that an endangered population is under constant threat of extinction.

D. **Correct.** The last sentence of the second paragraph states that the probability of extinction due to chance events is independent of how a population changes in size. Immediate extinction would more likely come from such events, whereas population decline is gradual, even if fairly rapid.

E. Endangered species, according to the second paragraph, may become extinct due to chance events—that is, events that have nothing to do with human activities.

The correct answer is D.

585. Which of the following most accurately describes the organization of the passage?

A. A question is raised, a distinction regarding it is made, and the question is answered.

B. An interpretation is presented, its soundness is examined, and a warning is given.

C. A situation is described, its consequences are analyzed, and a prediction is made.

D. Two interpretations of a phenomenon are described, and one of them is rejected as invalid.

E. Two methods for analyzing a phenomenon are compared, and further study of the phenomenon is recommended.

Evaluation

This question asks about the organization of the passage as a whole. In the first paragraph, the author tells about a situation that has been interpreted in a particular way by environmentalists. The passage then proceeds to consider whether that interpretation is valid, and while it does not come to a definitive conclusion on that point, the final paragraph warns about the possible consequences of not taking the action recommended by the environmentalists.

A. The passage does initially raise a question regarding whether the environmentalists' interpretation of events is valid, but it does not answer that question, for the appropriate long-term data are not available.

B. **Correct.** The passage presents environmentalists' interpretation of recent news regarding amphibians, then examines the soundness of that interpretation. Finally, the author warns that postponing environmental action may have disastrous consequences.

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action may have disastrous consequences.

C. The first paragraph describes a situation of possibly drastic declines in amphibian populations but does not follow this description with an analysis of its consequences.

D. The passage suggests that apparent declines in amphibian populations may or may not constitute a crisis, but it does not reject either idea.

E. While the passage does imply, in its final paragraph, that long-term data on amphibian populations should be collected, the passage does not compare two methods for analyzing amphibian populations or population declines in those populations.

The correct answer is B.

586. Which of the following best describes the function of the sentence in lines 35–38?

A. To give an example of a particular kind of study

B. To cast doubt on an assertion made in the previous sentence

C. To raise an objection to a view presented in the first paragraph

D. To provide support for a view presented in the first paragraph

E. To introduce an idea that will be countered in the following paragraph

Evaluation

The sentence in question discusses the way in which anecdotal reports of population decreases cannot help biologists determine whether those decreases are normal fluctuations, take populations to lower levels that are not actually worrisome, or actually threaten extinctions. This indicates that the view mentioned in the first paragraph—reports of declines indicate a catastrophic crisis—may be mistaken.

A. The sentence does not address a particular kind of study; it objects to the use of anecdotal reports in place of actual study.

B. The previous sentence describes the possibilities referred to in the sentence in question. The sentence does not cast doubt on any of those possibilities.

C. **Correct.** The view that reports of amphibian population declines indicate a crisis, as presented in the first paragraph, is countered by the objection here that there are several possible causes for population declines, and anecdotal reports cannot distinguish among those possibilities.

D. The first paragraph is concerned with articulating the view that amphibian population declines constitute a crisis. This sentence does not support that view; instead, it offers reason to question it.

E. The sentence introduces the idea that amphibian populations have fluctuated in the past, and the following paragraph supports this idea by stating that several amphibian species that appeared almost extinct in the 1950s and 1960s have recovered. Thus, the paragraph does not counter the sentence.

The correct answer is C.

Questions 587–590 refer to the passage on page 489.

Main Idea Summary

The main idea of the passage is that attempts to identify keystone species are complicated by multiple factors, including the difficulty of directly testing for keystone status with controlled experiments and the fact that keystone status appears to depend in complex ways on the contexts in which the species are found. The passage defines a keystone species as one whose effects on its ecosystem *are much larger than would be predicted from its abundance.* It notes that testing for keystone status by removing species from their environment and observing the effects of their absence is problematic. It then discusses one species of starfish to exemplify the difficulties inherent in determining whether a species is a keystone one. Drawing on those examples, the passage describes some ways in which keystone status depends on species' contexts.

587. The passage mentions which of the following as a factor that affects the role of *P. ochraceus* as a keystone species within different habitats?

A. The degree to which the habitat is sheltered from waves

B. The degree to which other animals within a habitat prey on mussels

C. The fact that mussel populations are often not dominant within some habitats occupied by *P. ochraceus*

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D. The size of the *P. ochraceus* population within the habitat

E. The fact that there is great species diversity within some habitats occupied by *P. ochraceus*

Supporting Idea

This question depends on recognizing what the passage states about the factors affecting *P. ochraceus*'s role as a keystone species, which is different in different habitats. According to the passage, *P. ochraceus* consumes and suppresses mussel populations in some habitats—specifically, those that are wave-exposed—making it a keystone predator in those habitats. But in wave-sheltered habitats, *P. ochraceus* does not play the same role in suppressing mussel populations.

A. **Correct.** The passage clearly states that *P. ochraceus*'s role in wave-exposed habitats differs from its role in wave-sheltered habitats.

B. The passage says that the impact of *P. ochraceus* predation on mussels is not strong in wave-sheltered habitats, but this is not the case—at least not at all sites—because other animals are preying on the mussels; rather, at least at some sites, it is because mussels are controlled by sand burial.

C. The passage does not suggest that mussel populations are dominant in any habitats occupied by *P. ochraceus*.

D. The size of the *P. ochraceus* population affects the size of the mussel population within wave-exposed habitats, but the passage does not suggest that *P. ochraceus*'s role as a keystone species depends on the size of its population within those habitats.

E. The only other species the passage mentions in conjunction with *P. ochraceus* habitats is the mussel; the passage does not address species diversity in these habitats.

The correct answer is A.

588. Which of the following hypothetical experiments most clearly exemplifies the method of identifying species' roles that the author considers problematic?

A. A population of seals in an Arctic habitat is counted in order to determine whether it is the dominant species in that ecosystem.

B. A species of fish that is a keystone species in one marine ecosystem is introduced into another marine ecosystem to see whether the species will come to occupy a keystone role.

C.

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